

NATIONAL AERONAUTICS AND SPACE ADMINISTRATION
NASA SHARED SERVICES CENTER

RECOMMENDATION AND DETERMINATION TO SOLICIT FROM ONE SOURCE
OR BRAND NAME

PICK ONE

Sole Source:

☒ I recommend that NASA, NASA Shared Services Center negotiate with Hitachi High-Tech Corporation only for Hitachi S-5200 SEM Service Contract. The total estimated cost of this effort is [REDACTED] and the estimated period of performance or lead-time for delivery is 04/05/2025 – 04/04/2026.

OR

Brand Name Justification:

☐ I recommend that NASA, NASA Shared Services Center negotiate only with vendors who can provide the subject brand name from Manufacture Name for Enter Supply or Service to be procured. The total estimated cost of this effort is Enter Dollar amount and the estimated period of performance or lead-time for delivery is Date.

This recommendation is for the acquisition of supplies or services determined to be reasonably available from only one source/only one manufacture. Competition is impractical for the following reasons (please answer the questions below):

1. **What are the reasons for soliciting only the suggested source/suggested brand name?** Please provide the unique characteristics of the items or services along with the supporting rationale and the market research performed to substantiate your reason for the suggested source/brand name.

The requested one-year service contract renewal from Hitachi Hitachi High-Tech is needed for a Hitachi high-resolution scanning electron microscope (HR-SEM), a highly complex and sensitive instrument. The instrument enables image capture with nanometer scale resolution and chemical analysis. The service contract will cover emergency service, short on-site service response time, preventive maintenance, and certain parts as specified in the quote. Maintaining a service contract enables the healthy operation of the equipment that allows uninterrupted research needs throughout the year. Repair and maintenance of the system cannot be carried out by anyone other than a trained and certified Hitachi technician specializing in this equipment.

2. **What is the impact to the government if another vendor/brand is used?** Include any dollar, schedule, or compatibility impacts if possible.

The HR-SEM is a basic materials research tool for nanomaterials characterization, and multiple projects use it to conduct research within the Advanced Materials and Processing Branch. Preventative maintenance and service is needed for the Hitachi HR-SEM to keep it in good working order. Without the service contract, the HR-SEM will not receive regular maintenance which could result in damage to the equipment. In addition, if the HR-SEM experience a failure, the service contract is needed to obtain immediate, emergency service to restore function. Without the service contract, failures could lead to long repair schedules and work stoppage for all projects using the HR-SEM.

ADDITIONAL COMMENTS:
